

	Agency Name	Office of Family Support (OFS)			
	Chapter No./Name	04 – Family Assistance Manual (FAM)			
	Part No./Name	B. Eligibility Factors (FITAP)			
	Section No./Name	B-500 Home (FITAP)			
	Document No./Name	B-520-FITAP Temporary Absence From Home			
	Dates	Issue	February 1, 2006	Effective	February 1, 2006

Do not deny benefits when the qualified relative or the child is temporarily out of the home.

If the temporary absence has been or is anticipated to continue beyond 45 days * but will not exceed 180 days:

- determine whether good cause for the absence exists in accordance with the Good Cause reasons cited below, and
- document the record to establish that the nature of the absence is temporary as evidenced by established plans for the return to the home.

Good Cause Reasons for Qualified Relative:

- the qualified relative is out of the home to attend school, training, or Job Corps and comes home at least twice a month to retain responsibility for the care and control of the child.
- the qualified relative is in a medical facility, psychiatric facility, or maternity home. A third party payee may be necessary during the absence of the caretaker relative.

Good Cause Reasons for Child:

- the child is out of the home for a visit including a two or three month summer vacation. (Three months is the maximum time allowed for an out of the home visit.)
- the child is out of the home to attend school, training, or Job Corps for 180 days or less and the caretaker relative is required to provide a portion of financial assistance and/or comes home on weekends.
- the child is in a medical facility, psychiatric facility, or maternity home for 180 days or less.
- additional good cause reasons may be determined on an individual case basis. Supervisory approval and documentation is required.

B-520-1-FITAP Removal of Child or Case Closure Due to Absence From the Home.

Remove the needs of a child that is expected to be out of the home for a visit longer than 3 months when it is known that the absence will exceed 3 months.

Remove the needs of a child that is expected to be out of the home for longer than 180 days when it is known that the absence will exceed 180 days.

Close a FITAP/KCSP case once it is known that the only child in the home is expected to be absent from the home for a visit longer than 3 months.

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Close a FITAP/KCSP case once it is known that the only qualified relative or only child in the home is expected to be absent from the home for longer than 180 days when it is known that the absence will exceed 180 days.

Note: Advance notice is required for removal of a child or for closure of a FITAP/KCSP case.

B-520-2-FITAP Reporting Requirement

If the payee failed to timely report a child's absence of more than a 45 day duration and good cause for the absence is not established:

- determine the first month of overpayment or ineligible payment based on the effective month the child should have been removed from the grant, and
- exclude the needs of the child(ren) in determining the amount of the overpayment or ineligible payment, or
- exclude the needs of the payee as well as the child(ren) in determining the amount of the overpayment or ineligible payment if no eligible child or caretaker relative remained in the home.

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B-521-FITAP ASSISTANCE FOR HOMELESS FAMILIES

Do not deny assistance solely because the assistance unit does not reside at a fixed address or in a permanent dwelling. For purpose of this policy, a home is defined as the family setting maintained by the relative with whom the child lives as evidenced by the fact that the relative assumes responsibility for the day to day care of the child.

Assist the homeless client to establish a mailing address which will ensure regular and timely receipt of agency correspondence. This could be the parish office, a local non-profit agency or local Post Office.

NOTE: These clients must meet the residency requirement. See [B-910-FITAP](#).